ACTIVITY REPORT 2023-2024



Report by:

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Project title	**"Empowering unorganized women workers and Adolescent girls as potential income generators and budding contributor for environment protection".**

Overview of the project Report

The project is proposed in Mugaiyur block of Villupuram district, Tamilnadu state, India which is identified as backward blocks in the parameters of poverty, education, health and industrial establishment (Ref: www.tn.gov.in/spc).

11873 families are living below the poverty line in this block. Agriculture is the main occupation of these families. Due to the monsoon failure even agriculture is not the source to earn the daily bread of the people now a days. To manage the financial crisis, these people go for daily wages and some of them migrate to nearby states or city in search of jobs. Among these workers women and adolescent girls are the one who affected most.

The workers involved in unorganized labour work are involved in unprotected labouring. These workers also migrate frequently in search of job. Because of the frequent migration in search of job also affects the education of the children. Some of their children are forced to work in a unsafe situation. Their capacity to think for another stable income source is very low or nil.

The low income they earn from unorganised labouring, they could not meet their family expenses completely. They are unable to afford to provide nutritious food to all the family members. They maximum live in a hut. Their health practices unhygienic. They drink and use the water which is available at the working place which makes them to fall in sick frequently. They also do their defecation near to their living place which is the main cause for the spread of diseases.

This project indents to address the main problems that the unorganised women workers face often. The project also contribute for the protection of the environment

All the selected beneficiary population belongs to the schedule caste (SC) community which is the most disadvantaged community in India. In general, the socio-economic condition of this community is very poor due to the social exclusion and multidimensional discrimination faced by this community for ages. In specific, three out of four Dalit households in rural Tamil Nadu state are landless and dependent on manual casual labour for their livelihood as per the Socio Economic and Caste Census data 2011. The state has the third highest number of SC population in the country with 25.5% total rural population being SCs. And the state's average percentage of SCs homes without land and earning their income from labour is 73 per cent. Tamilnadu is considered to be one of the developed states, 78 per cent of Dalits drawing less than Rs 5000 per month.

Livelihood:

Majority villagers are landless and depends on agriculture and construction labour works. About 25% households have less than 1 acre land, but the cultivation is rare due to unavailability of water. Even during rainy seasons there is no agriculture activity as the rains have been irregular for the last 4 years.

Most of the women mainly engaged in MNEGAS (Employment Guarantee scheme) works and earn minimum wage for 100 days in a year. Few men and women also engage in casuarina cutting works. The agriculture labour works are available for about week to 10 days in a month. Few families also working in Brick Kilns outside village. They stay outside for 2 to 3 months leaving school age children with grandparents.

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Mobilizing unorganized Women labours and adolescent girls as a workers group

Equip the community in the aspects of Solid Waste Management

Generating Alternative income source for the families of Unorganised Workers.

Empowering women and adolescent girls as a potential contributor for environment protection

Generating awareness on environmental issues Promotion of clean, healthy and eco friendly environment
300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls will be involved income generating activity is economically autonomic at the end of the action. The beneficiaries are able to invest and develop further their business without any additional funding; Beneficiaries have opened savings bank accounts; The group credit linkages will provide option for marketing at small & medium scale business hub. Involvement of women in households' decision making – particularly on issues such as children's education, health and hygiene – compared to the first baseline; Women and adolescent girlsfind respect and dignity in entire community. Promotion of gender equality Promotion of clean environment in all 10 panchayats

Project results

1.Solid Waste management group has been formed in all villages
2.Solid waste management Trainings has been imparted to women
3. Solid waste management units have been established in all 10 panchayats
4.Materials have been procured for the usage of Solid waste management activities

Achieved results	Describe the target group reached	How was this result achieved?
1.Solid Waste management group has been formed in all villages	300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls have been organised as groups in 10 villages. All the beneficiaries are in the age group between 18 - 45	Entry point meetings have been conducted in all 10 panchayats with all stakeholders and community. Beneficiaries identification is done in each village with the support of local volunteers. Initial group meetings were organised in each village and project orientation was given to them.
2.Solid waste management Trainings has been imparted to women	300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls have been trained in Solid waste management process. All the beneficiaries are in the age group between 18 - 45	Resource person for the training have been arranged from govt department. Training schedule have been made batch wise at ACT campus. Each batch women have been trained for 6 days in solid waste management process.
3. Solid waste management units have been established in all 10 panchayats	300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls have been reached through this activity. All the beneficiaries are in the age group between 18 - 45	Common place for Solid waste management unit establishment have been mobilized from local village panchayat. Waste management pit construction have been done in all 10 villages
4. Solid waste management group has started its functioning in the villages	300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls are the direct beneficiaries reached through this activity.	300 unorganised women workers and adolescent girls have started doing solid waste management at their villages using the vehicles that we distributed and using the waste management pits that we have constructed in all 10 villages.
Environment protection awareness creation part is still not achieved as all these first three months have been spent on group formation, Skill training, material procurement and initiating the solid waste management activities. Tree plantation and awareness creation programmes will be organised in		

coming days.

As the women have been trained on solid waste management, they actively take part in the process through collection of wastages and processing them as degradable and non degradable wastage. This activity also help them to earn income by selling the vermin compost produced through degradable waste and plastics sold for recycling units.

Challenges, solutions and lessons learned

The communities which are located in nearby villages started approaching ACT to implement the same project in their village also. ACT team has organised meeting with village officials and explained the financial difficulties to execute the project in all villages.

The biggest lesson which ACT team has learned in the process of execution of the project is " When we put forth community in front in the social development projects and guide them properly on the process, The result will be more than the Target"

Monitoring and evaluation

ACT played the role of implementer by mobilizing the women and adolescent girls to involve in the project.

ACT also mobilized govt support in getting the place for waste management pit construction and collecting the waste at doorsteps in the villages.

Target group is also played vital role in the implementation of the project with their fullest cooperation and arranging the things in their respective villages which all are required for the implementation of the project.

Durability of the project

The project is implemented in the targeted villages with the effective participation of the community. The existing CBOs have been strengthened and involved effectively in the project activities. This will make the CBOs and the stakeholders to monitor the activities, plan the future activities and leverage resources for the sustainability of the activities after the project period.

Self Help groups(SHGs) are the vibrant actors in social and economic development of the villages. When SHGs are linked with the project activities they will discuss and take possible actions even after the project duration.

Panchayat Raj Institution is the local level governance which handles number of schemes and programmes. Since the Linkages with Panchayat raj made strong during the project period, the proposed activities of the project will also be interlinked with the ongoing programmes of Panchayat raj after the project period in all 10 villages.

During the end of the project periods this solid waste management activities will be very well linked with the supporting agency like govt departments, Financial institutions and other CBOs which would support the activity fullest to run without any problems.

Panchayat raj Institution have been linked with the activities, which will be clubbed with ongoing schemes of the government.

The solid waste management groups have been arranged to save corpus fund in all the groups to meet challenging financial crisis in the future

All ACT team have been given complete orientation on the project activities.

Technical people for solid waste management process have been availed from govt departments to train the staff and the target people.

Lobby and policy influencing

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The Self Help Groups which are functioning in the villages have been linked with the women solid waste management activities to tackle the financial crisis of the women in the future.

Solid waste management technical inputs were collected from rural development department of Villupuram district.

Place for the solid waste management pit construction have been mobilized from Panchayat raj department of Mugaiyur block

Case Studies:



Name: Mrs Saresvathi and The Solid Waste Management and environment Protection Group members in Kandachipuram Village

There were lot of programmes implemented in our village by government and private agencies. But no programme except ACT organized the village people and involved them to take care of their own needs. ACT has been implementing several programmes from the past in our village. All the programmes are implemented with mobilization of the community. In that line, this solid waste management programme also involved community specially women and adolescent girls to take care of our village environment and also provides the way for economic improvement. Personally we learned lot about solid waste management through the training organized by ACT in this project.

Through the training our village women and adolescent girls are motivated and we are doing our best to keep our village clean by making the solid waste management in our village itself.

Thanks a lot for ACT to include our village in the programme. We will make our group in Kandachipuram village a best one in solid waste management process.

